

EDUCATION	Columbia University 2024 – Present M.A. in Media Studies & Sociology Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu GPA 3.97/4.00 Thesis: <i>Social Vulnerabilities of Large Language Models</i> Brigham Young University–Hawaii 2022 – 2024 B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science Research Advisor: Mason Allred GPA 3.81/4.00
AREAS OF INTEREST	Social Impacts of AI; Social Media; Well-Being; Trust & Deception; Human-AI Collaboration
BOOK	[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati. Emilio Barkett <i>Barnes and Noble Press</i>, 2022.
PUBLICATIONS	[3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs. Emilio Barkett, Olivia Long, Paul Kröger <i>AAAI</i>, 2026. [under review] [arXiv]. [2] Don't Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models. Paul Kröger, Emilio Barkett <i>AAAI</i>, 2026. [under review] [1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs. Emilio Barkett, Olivia Long, Madhavendra Thakur <i>ICML</i>, 2025. [arXiv].
WORKS IN PROGRESS	[3] Imagining the Future: Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development. Emilio Barkett <i>Working Paper</i>. [2] Evaluating AI Persuasion Across Socioeconomic Status. Emilio Barkett, Robin Hart <i>Working Paper</i>. [1] Risk, Rationality, and Drift: Institutional Factors in the Normalization of Deviance in AGI Systems. Emilio Barkett <i>Working Paper</i>.
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Columbia Business School New York, NY June 2025 – Present Researcher Research Advisor: Alan Zhang - Qualitatively investigating how emerging player performance technologies are adopted in amateur competitive youth sports. Columbia AI Alignment Club New York, NY March 2025 – Present Principal Investigator Research Advisors: Yau-Meng Wong, Paul Kröger - Formed research agenda; created experimental design; led writing; technical implementation of Python/API calls; mentored four undergraduate collaborators; managed publication timeline. Columbia University New York, NY Jan 2025 – Present Research Assistant Research Advisor: James Chu - Regression analysis in R; data cleaning; synthesized literature review; prepared survey data; contributed to manuscript structure; asymmetrical collaboration.

	Brigham Young University–Hawaii <i>UX Research Associate</i> Research Advisors: Curtis Lefrandt, Scott Stiles Ethnographic fieldwork to identify user pain points; synthesized insights into journey maps; presented policy recommendations to the University President’s Council.	Oahu, HI June 2023 – June 2024
	Brigham Young University–Hawaii <i>Data Scientist</i> University surveys through Qualtrics; analyzed data in R; presented to executive leadership.	Oahu, HI April 2022 – June 2023
AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club. Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500. Dean’s List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500.	Jan 2025 – Present 2022 2022
PRESENTATIONS	Conferences - AAAI 2026, Singapore, January 2026. <i>Getting out of the Big Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs</i> [Submitted] - AAAI 2026, Singapore, January 2026. <i>Don’t Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models</i> [Submitted] - Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - ICML 2025 Workshop, Vancouver, Canada, July 2025. <i>Reasoning Isn’t Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs</i> - Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. <i>Surveillance on University Campuses</i> - Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. <i>Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative</i>	
ACADEMIC SERVICE	Reviewer - Conferences: NeurIPS (2025) - Workshops: Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modelling Research (COLM 2025), AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026) Academic Groups - Sociology of Expertise Working Group, International Sociological Association. June 2025 – Present - Media in the Digital Age Interest Group, Allan Turing Institute. Oct 2024 – Present - Science, Knowledge, and Technology Workshop, Columbia University. Aug 2024 – Present	
RESEARCH METHODS	Quantitative Research: Survey design, regression analysis, text analysis, web prototyping, computational social science, machine learning, natural language processing Qualitative Research: Ethnographic field research, interviews, focus groups, content analysis, speculative methods, think-aloud protocol, usability testing	
COMPUTER & CODE	Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SPSS, Qualtrics, L ^A T _E X	
LANGUAGES	English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)	